

then later building it up to three months' living expenses (see my previous book).

However, you may be wondering why a teenager needs a Mojo account when they're living with their parents: aren't parents the ultimate Mojo account?

Yes, you are.

Yet there's going to come a time when your kids aren't living with you anymore (promise).

It kind of just creeps up on you without you noticing—until the day it happens. Either your kid goes off to university, or they decide they want their own space. However it happens, in the space of a whirlwind month or two they go from grunting at your dinner table to walking out the door and becoming a fully fledged adult.

For most young people that's when reality sets in. 'Things are so, like, expensive.'

There's four weeks' rent. There's four weeks' bond. There's furniture and furnishing costs. And so when the bank sends that credit card application via email (just for emergencies, of course), they think to themselves:

Finally I'm being treated like a card-carrying adult! And besides, the bank wouldn't be offering me a credit card if they didn't think I could pay it back, would they? This is just what adults do, right?

And then, like a friendly drug dealer, the bank offers to keep increasing the credit card limit.

Until they're hooked.

As I'm writing this, here's the lead story in *The Age* . . . (Which bank? The Dollarmites Bank.)

BANKING ROYAL COMMISSION

'138 years to pay off debt': David asked the CBA for help. So they gave him more